

It works by integrating three types of functionality into the device:

- **Motion-tracking:** This feature tracks the various visual features of the environment, objects in your vicinity etc. With the aid of an accelerometer and a gyroscope, it provides a fairly accurate tracking of the immediate space around the device.
- **Area Learning:** The allows the device to store tracking data, creating a “map” of the environment which it can bring up later. This data can also be shared with other Tango devices and users can enhance this data with additional metadata.
- **Depth perception:** Perception of distances, sizes, surfaces, heights etc in the environment.

In combination, the three functionalities provide pretty detailed three-dimensional data about the environment.

As of right now, Tango and the Tango SDK are only available for the Asus ZenFone AR and the Lenovo Phab 2 Pro smartphones. Tango supports the C/C++, Unity3D and Java APIs.

Tango AR content is distributed through the Google Play Store. For everything else AR related, Google now has ARCore.

ARCore

Tango heavily depended on hardware to function and was thus limited to specific devices (like we mentioned above, only two so far). ARCore brings AR to devices without the need for all that fancy hardware, making it readily available for millions of users. You will still need an “AR-ready”

